

Climate-Smart Farm Monitoring and Early Warning System: An IT-Enabled Solution to Severe Climate Vulnerability and Crop Losses in the Philippines

Author: Ella Sofia M. Asentista

Course: BS Biology Major in Medical Biology

Date: August 18, 2026

Introduction

The Philippines is highly vulnerable to climate-related hazards such as typhoons, floods, droughts, and extreme heat. These hazards pose a serious threat to agriculture because climate shocks can damage crops, irrigation systems, post-harvest facilities, and rural roads while disrupting the transportation and supply of agricultural products (World Bank, 2023).

Agricultural losses caused by climate-related events are already substantial. Data from the Department of Agriculture show that from 2013 to 2022, **98% of agricultural production losses were associated with climate-related hazards**, amounting to approximately **₱299.8 billion**. Rice accounted for around **36%** of these losses, while typhoons caused approximately **88% of total production damage** during the period (Department of Agriculture, n.d.).

Because farmers depend heavily on weather and environmental conditions, having access to timely and localized information can help them make better decisions. Technology can support farmers by providing weather forecasts, monitoring farm conditions, identifying possible risks, and giving recommendations before severe weather causes major crop damage.

Problem Description

Climate change creates difficulties for Filipino farmers because weather conditions are becoming increasingly unpredictable. Typhoons and heavy rainfall can cause flooding and crop destruction, while drought and extreme heat can reduce water availability and negatively affect crop growth. These climate shocks can eventually contribute to food shortages, increased food insecurity, and economic losses (World Bank, 2023).

One major problem is that farmers need **timely and location-specific information** to prepare for these hazards. General weather information may not always tell a farmer what action should be taken for a particular crop or farm. For example, a farmer may need to know whether to harvest early before a typhoon, adjust a planting schedule because of expected drought, or increase irrigation because of dry conditions.

Existing government initiatives show that technology can already support this need. DOST-PAGASA provides agricultural weather forecasts and advisories that recommend actions such as adjusting planting, spraying, and harvesting schedules based on expected rainfall. (PAGASA) PhilRice has also developed digital farming tools that allow farmers and local government units to record farm activities, monitor field conditions, and generate crop recommendations based on local conditions (PhilRice, 2026).

However, there is an opportunity to integrate these different sources of information into one accessible system that provides farmers with **early warnings, farm monitoring, and personalized recommendations**.

Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is a **Climate-Smart Farm Monitoring and Early Warning System (CS-FMEWS)**—a mobile and web-based platform designed to help Filipino farmers monitor climate risks and protect their crops.

The system would combine information from **DOST-PAGASA weather forecasts, satellite data, farm records, soil conditions, and crop information**. Through these data sources, the system could identify possible risks such as heavy rainfall, flooding, drought, extreme heat, and other conditions that may threaten crops.

The platform would provide farmers with **real-time alerts and simple recommendations** through a mobile application. For example, when a strong typhoon is approaching, the system could notify farmers to harvest mature crops early, secure farm structures, or protect equipment. During periods of expected drought, it could recommend adjustments to irrigation and planting schedules.

This type of technology is realistic because the Philippines is already developing digital agricultural systems. The Department of Agriculture's Agro-Climatic Advisory Portal integrates weather information from PAGASA and provides updated weather information and crop-specific recommendations to agricultural stakeholders.

Key Features of the Proposed System

1. Climate and Weather Alerts

The system would receive weather and climate information from DOST-PAGASA and convert it into simple farmer-friendly alerts.

2. Crop Risk Monitoring

Farmers could register their:

- Location
- Crop type
- Planting date
- Farm size
- Current crop condition

The system would then assess possible climate risks to the farmer's specific crop.

3. AI-Based Risk Prediction

An AI component could analyze historical weather, satellite images, soil information, and farm records to identify patterns associated with crop stress or potential crop losses.

AI-based agricultural systems can use satellite, weather, soil, and field data to estimate yields and detect early signs of crop stress or failure (World Bank, 2026). (World Bank)

4. Personalized Farming Recommendations

Instead of simply telling farmers that bad weather is coming, the application would provide **recommended actions**.

For example:

Drought predicted → conserve water, adjust irrigation, and consider drought-tolerant crops.

Heavy rainfall predicted → improve drainage, protect farm structures, and consider early harvesting.

Extreme heat predicted → increase monitoring of crop stress and adjust irrigation.

5. Crop Damage Reporting

After a disaster, farmers could upload photographs and information about damaged crops. The data could help local governments and agricultural agencies quickly identify affected areas and estimate agricultural losses.

Satellite and digital agricultural technologies are already being explored in the Philippines for flood mapping, crop monitoring, irrigation planning, and disaster assistance. (DA Official Portal)

6. Offline/SMS Accessibility

Because not all farmers have reliable internet access, important warnings could also be sent through **SMS**. The system could therefore remain useful even when farmers have limited mobile data or connectivity.

V. Expected Impact

The proposed system is expected to help reduce climate-related crop losses by allowing farmers to **prepare before hazards occur rather than simply respond after damage has already happened**.

The system can potentially:

- Improve farmers' access to timely climate information
- Reduce preventable crop losses
- Help farmers make better planting and harvesting decisions

- Improve water and resource management
- Support faster reporting of agricultural damage
- Help government agencies identify high-risk areas
- Strengthen food security and farmer resilience

The World Bank identifies digital agriculture and information systems as important investments for improving farm decision-making, resource management, and climate resilience in the Philippines. (World Bank)

The proposed system would also complement existing government programs. The Department of Agriculture's **Adapting Philippine Agriculture to Climate Change (APA) Project** aims to provide localized climate information services and promote climate-resilient agricultural practices among vulnerable farming communities. (APA Project)

VI. Limitations and Considerations

Although technology can help farmers prepare for climate hazards, the proposed system cannot completely prevent crop losses. Weather predictions and AI-generated recommendations may contain uncertainty, and their accuracy depends on the quality of available data.

The system would also require reliable data collection, internet or telecommunications infrastructure, farmer training, and coordination between government agencies. The World Bank emphasizes that digital agriculture can improve decision-making, but technology must be supported by appropriate infrastructure, data systems, and farm-management practices. (World Bank)

Therefore, the system should **support rather than replace farmers' knowledge and decision-making**.

VII. Conclusion

Severe climate vulnerability and crop losses are major problems facing Philippine agriculture. With approximately **₱299.8 billion in agricultural production losses associated with climate-related hazards from 2013 to 2022**, farmers need better ways to anticipate and respond to climate risks (Department of Agriculture, n.d.). (AMIA Program)

The proposed **Climate-Smart Farm Monitoring and Early Warning System** uses mobile technology, weather data, satellite information, farm records, and AI-assisted analysis to provide farmers with timely warnings and practical recommendations. By connecting climate information with farm-level decision-making, the system can help farmers prepare for extreme weather, manage resources more effectively, and reduce avoidable crop losses.

Ultimately, technology alone cannot stop typhoons, droughts, or extreme heat. However, **better information can give farmers more time to prepare, adapt, and protect their livelihoods**. Building a more digitally connected and climate-resilient agricultural sector can contribute to a more secure food supply and a more resilient Philippines.

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